

Interview 1

. Hey, good afternoon, Kevin. How are you doing this morning? Or this afternoon? Doing well, Christopher. How are you? Doing well. Doing well. Thanks for taking the time to meet with me today. First of, I don't know if you remember, we actually met several years ago. Yeah, Andrew actually showed me the picture and he he kind of like misspoke and he said it was like, um the hiring manager was a woman. And I was like, you know I don't remember her. And then, you know, I saw your name yesterday and I was like, Christopher Walker. And I looked you up on LinkedIn and then I saw the picture again. And I was like, yes, I remember him. I was like, I know we met multiple times through those undercurrent events, you know, many years ago. Yeah, many years ago. And I was like, wow, I'm not, I wasn't in a very different place then than I am now, which is just funny to think about. If I first off, if I remember directly here Filipino right? Yes. Okay. And I'm actually half. Yeah, I remember that. Yeah, yeah. So cool stuff. We can certainly talk more about some Rumpia and available whatever more. But cool. Cool. Again, thanks for taking the time. Maybe just to kind of, you know, start off, you know, when we first met in 2018, I was actually an analyst and loss prevention. Okay. I was I started my career. I was on eight years ago as a I prevention analyst. A year and a half into that, I got promoted to merchandising analysts and then then into senior analyst, and then I was promoted nearly two years ago to merchandiseising analytics manager. So regardless of this, the needless to say, there's definitely plenty of opportunity for growth here at AutoZone. just to kind of give you a high aware of view, what my team does, my team acts as really the business consultants for the merchandising department. My team, I actually have really two teams. I have my analyst team that works here in Memphis, and then I have a team based in Chhuaha, Mexico, and they're responsible for all our KPR reporting, whether that's automated Excel reporting automated dashboarding. The analyst can do some of that as well. They may build ad hoc reporting, they may build generic KPI reporting for the teams they support. And they may also build dashboards as well. It's something that we've been very big into as of late. But needless to say, we do work specifically with our category manager or our buyers such as Andrew and provide them data and help paint a story for them, and tell them to try to explain, what does the data say and what kind of insights can they take away to help drive initiatives and drive cells? Yeah, and that's really about it. Could tell me a little bit more about yourself, what you had been doing lately? Yeah, so, I mean, you know, when we met, I was working at Pfizer I'm not sure, you know exactly when, but I had a I had multiple roles while I was at Pfizer. I started out, you know, in the finance space. I was a decision support analyst. So I was kind of like working, you know, in the weeds of Excel, creating dashboards, creating reports for financial planning analysts to review. And I was kind of coming up and helping them meet their KPIs and explain to them like what decisions based on the numbers, like what they might need to take. From there, I kind of had an opportunity, still within Pfizer, that they were rolling out an RA software. So robotic process automation. I was part of the pilot program that was for for the Excel reporting. And so joining that, I kind of was interested in that a little bit more and, you know, luckily, a role opened up. So I applied for it and kind of moved into out of the finance space, into a little bit more of a, what, Pizer calls a digitalital or like technology organization within Pfizer. So from there, I was kind of like working with process documentations, working with different teams and kind of like more of a business analyst, liaising with a technical team in the business team. And then, again, like there was another opportunity to move up to a manager-level position within Pfizer. So I kind of

took that and kind of like went through multiple rounds of reorganizations. So I ended up and landed, finally like a space after reorganizations of data enablement. So that was kind of like tracking metadata through the different partners within within Pfizer, making sure that their data lineage and metadata was tracked from A to Z, kind of understanding where the ET processes took place and the transformations that how it ended up. So that was like my journey. in Pfizer. It ended middle of last year due to reorganizations. I was impacted by a layoff. So I've been kind of working through that, you know, last year, I took some time to like myself and travel, but, you know, this 2026, I'm kind of like really ramping it up and working through some interviews and trying to get back to it. Okay, cool. Definitely hate to hear about layoffs. I know that's been kind of a trendous of light in general for a lot of people. So it's never really fun to hear about that. And, you know, when people lose when companies lose their people, you know, other opportunities right for other teams pick up great people, right? So hopefully we can find a fit for you here. So, can you tell me a little bit more about like, you know, the type of data work that you have done in just general? Yeah, so I would say if you're looking, are you looking for something specific like data analytics like dashboarding or more what type of data work are you definitely working for? Yeah, yeah, let me rephrase that. So, yeah, tell me about times that you have done data analysis. You know, what was the problem you're trying to solve for? Yeah, what was the problem you were trying to solve for? How did you solve it? What were some of the tools you used and what was the ultimate solution? Yes, I would say kind of like there's two different areas of data that I kind of like worked with and I kind of mentioned would say the first one, like some of the tools that I've worked with, in my my most recent position was we were working with the software at Calibra. And so this is part of like the liaison with like the business and working with their getting their data onto our collibra platform. Most of the time, I would be working in between like the technical team and the business. Seeing what requirements are needed to get their data to our platform that includes what security access is needed, what role-based controls, and from there, it kind of was a, like a checklist of like, okay, is this data work? Is this data on board? Is this correct? And yes, so like it would kind of be like a back and forth between, is this a green light or is this a red light? Do we need to work and see and investigate further what could have happened between like the data transfer? Okay.. No, so cool. And you do have experience with tab, right? could tell me a little bit about that and kind of your process of like, how do you determine what you put into tableau in terms of a report? I'm sorry, I didn't catch the end. And, like, could you tell me a little bit more about your experience with Tab and how potentially you would want to visualize on the tableau dashboard? I'm sorry, I was a raising the volume, but here. You're good. Yeah, like, just tell me a little bit more about the tablo experience that you've had. So a little bit of a tablo experience I've had, I haven't had necessarily too much direct work with tableau. Most of the time, I'm using pre-existing dashboards and sort of creating the story that like I need to tell. So for for instance, like, I would want to make sure if if our data was on board into the Clevever software, I'm looking at how many how many things pass and how many things fail, according to what has been transferred transferred over. So after that, I'm kind of like looking at where do I see, where can I see like the key factors that I need to make and talk with the business and see what they need to decide, whether those issues can be dealt with at a later time. Okay. And how do you determine or like, how do you determine what kind of how you would want to visualize data? Like, like, just opinion on the data itself or how did you do that? how I would determine what, what the data it look like.

Yeah, yeah. I. It kind of depends on, like, who the audience is that I'm reporting the data to. So typically, if it was someone at a manager level that I'm colleagues with, it would kind of be a working session between me and me and them. But usually, if it's over level management, I would kind of consult and see what exactly decision factors they're looking at and kind of tailored to to decisions that they're trying to look for. I. No, that's absolutely what I would I look for. I know very different from a lot of the other and so they' regard in them this interview process, but I think definitely I like the insight. I appreciate that. So maybe a little bit more abstract, if you will. I'm going to just give you an example. What if I were to tell you that we see a correlation between car wash accessories and Coca Cola cells. What does it tell you and what would you potentially go do with that data? You said. You said car wash sales or car wash accessories? Car wash accessories. Car wash accessories, and Coca-Cola sales. Yeah. I would probably try to see who the audience is and see first off where the correlation between the regions, you know, whether that could be like, could be difference between the snow belt and the sunbelt region in the US. But I think that's the first thing I would try to take a look at is like, where is the correlation happening? And then I think the decisions I would try to take is, you know, based on like the not just the location, but the time of the year. I would assume that if it's like summertime and like car wash accessories are being, I guess we said sold more. I would try to maybe some kind of some kind of coral connection between between the time and like between the time and like those two those two things.. Yeah. No, absolutely. I could definitely tell you. It's definitely there is a correlation to time of year. So there's definitely a very interesting relationship there based off time of year. So, okay, cool. Like, so sometimes, you know,. You've kind of mentioned this already, but you know, depending on the level that you're speaking to, right, the type of communication you have changes. So could you try to explain correlation to me as if I were a 12 year old? as if you were a 12 year old. Yeah. Okay. Um.. Or it doesn't have to be a, but. It could be like, like, explain to me like I'm an executive, and not saying that executives are 12 or year olds, but sometimes they don't have the background, right? So how do you explain it more in layman's? I would probably try to, yeah, what you said, explain it in a little bit of layman's terms, but I think if we're going with like the example of the car wash accessories and the Coca-Cola sales, I would say I would try to create the story and create the picture of imagine yourself washing your car in the summer, what's maybe the first thing you want to want to grab, like in the heat of the summer, you may want some water, you may want a little bit of a little sugar, so you may want a Coke. And the what would be the correlation be the feeling or the the maybe the want of wanting something cold and refreshing so that is the correlation between like the car wash and the Cope. There's there's a want or a need between those two. Yeah. Go with that. Okay, cool. Thank you. No, definitely appreciate that. So, can you tell me a little bit more, like, in terms of data, would you say that, you know, analysts kind of fall on different spectrums, if you will. How would you describe yourself? Would you describe yourself as more data engineer, Data kind of someone that's more on the data governance integrity side, someone that is more on the analysis reporting side insights or maybe even data signs. Or who do you say you fall on that? If we're kind of like looking at that spectrum, I would lean towards the, what you said, like the data governments and like the data analyst side. More of like a hybrid between those two. not really the data engineering as I didn't really have too much responsibilities with data engineering in my previous roles. But I would say that between like the hybrid of that data analytics and the camera with what you said, but Yeah, analytics and

governance. Yeah, I would lean in more towards the data governance just based on my previous experience, but also with having like highlights of the data analytics and dashboarding and sort of that storytelling aspect of what is like the data analytics and dashboarding. Okay, cool. Now, could you, like, one thing I don't really exactly see on your resume, and I feel like I get hints of it, but, you know, what kind of tools do you use? You use. I see that you do have some tab experience, but do you have any experienced leveraging, say, are you on sequel, not saying that you need those for this role, but are some of the more technical skills set that you may have? Yeah, yeah, I would say a lot of the technical skill sets that rely on them on my previous roles. I think I mentioned some of the softwares that we used, but in general, definitely we use a lot of Excel. So I'm like well- vers in like creating different tables within and dashboards within Excel. So along with that is the more like the VBA coding in Excel is something we used heavily in my previous roles. And then. out of those other three you mentioned are Python and sequel. I use sequel, not on a day-to-day basis, but I would say more on a. a weekly basis, more troubleshooting, how the how the data that came into our platform, how it came through. So whether there was issues, I would take a look at, I would take a look at the statements and see what possibly needed to change, whether it was a whether it needed to be like a left or a right joint or whether it needed to be in or out or, it kind of depended on the issue at the time. So it was not something I worked on on a daily basis. Okay. Oh, cool. Yeah, and really, you know, I think if you know enough sequel, I mean, that's the important thing, right? And we do a lot of troubleshooting in general, just so we try to validate data points, making sure that do we feel How do we fill out the data and just build a general opinion on it? Okay, um. Trees like, I don't really have many more questions for you. Um, you know, and interviews are two way streets, so I'm gonna open it up to you. Do you have any questions for me? Yeah, I am. So I know, Andrew kind of was the one who kind of showed me this job opening. And I know it says the title is merch analyst. And I when I was talking with Shipper, the one who set this up, I didn't get a strong understanding of where this kind of sat in in your organization, you know, whether this is you're looking for like an entry-level position, like a senior analyst level or a manager, individual contributor type of role. So I was kind of wondering if you could help me understand where this kind of sits within your organization. Absolutely. Right now, we're really looking for this is, well, we certainly have people that come in and entry level roles for this position. It doesn't always mean that it's entry level. Really, the job of the analyst is an IC role. So you're going to be working very closely with our category managers and provide data analysis for them. Once you get into the senior analyst role, that is probably where you get into more into more management. So the senior analysts have analysts that report to them as well. And so the senior analysts get that experience of, well, and still being an IC, but they also get the experience of management as well. So that kind of gets until more of a hybrid. And then from the senior analysts, you get into the manager, which is the current my current spot. And so right now I have three senior analysts on the team, and then we have three regular analysts. Okay. Yeah. And so there's certainly an opportunity to grow into the senior analyst spot. So coming into the role doesn't mean that you won't get the senior analyst spot, right? Because there's only three there's that potential for that growth as well. So am I understanding you have three senior analysts and then also three merch analysts or similar level to that. And this would be coming in at the merch analyst level. Yes. Okay. Yep. Yep. And so, yeah, they were like, we're trying to fill that fourth merch analyst spot. Okay. And then I guess the other question kind of along with

the the role, I didn't see it on the job description, but in Shipper was a must have had a. had a number in mind, but she was I was trying to ask, like, what is like the range that upper bound that you're looking for for this type of merch analyst role? What do you mean by upper bound? Upper round salary range, sorry. A salary Salary range. Okay. I would actually have to ask Shipper what it is these days, but you're probably looking around, probably around 90 to 95. Okay? Then then there's also a bonus that comes with it. So at the merch analyst f that bonus is around 10% of that salary. So think about an additional 9K or nine and 5K. So yeah. Okay. I think the other question I had, I had something in mind, but kind of just lost it, but um I guess like depending on, you know, how how you feel in your team feels like on other applications? Like, what is the next steps of the process of this? Okay, yeah, absolutely. So just in terms of the next steps, what we would do is you would we'd have there's really four more interviews left in the process. You'll interview with one of my senior analysts. You'll interview with one of another merchandising manager, analyst manager, you'll meet with one of our merchandising category directors who happens to be Andrew's old boss. And you would meet with my boss, David Strickland after that. And then we'll probably make a decision from there. Okay. And that's good to know. Yeah. So, yeah, we want to make sure you get a good exposure to people who you may be working with in the organization. Yeah, absolutely. Okay. But, no. Thank you for thank you for those answers, Christopher, but no other questions for me kind of looking forward to next steps. I got, perfect. Thank you, Kevin. Thank you for your time. And if you have any questions in the meantime, don't hesit hit to reach out, okay? Awesome. Okay. Awesome. Take a sure your time. Thank you.. Bye.

Interview 2

Hello? Hey, Kevin, can you hear me? Yeah. Hey, how are you doing? Doing well. How are you? Good. I'm doing well. Sorry about that at that. some technical difficulties for a second. So nice to meet you. My name is Adam Sander. I think we could just dive right into it. So I'll do you a little bit of encrypt to myself and I'm going to hand it over to you, all right? All right. Cool. So, like I said, my name is Adam Kander. I'm currently a commercial pricing manager here at AutoZone. My team currently is responsible for all the pricing related stuff for related on our BB side of the business. We handle more of the data science and analytics, R&D kind of stuff. I'm a 10 year auto owner. starting my career off as an intern, my background is saying accounting. I did a couple different stints my first year and a half to as an intern, and then kind of got pulled into the basement crew of things, to spend a lot of time on our retail side of the business, supporting pricing and merchandising. And then I actually worked for a year, a couple of years on the team that you actually interviewing for. was an animal on that team for a bit and before making a transition over to our VV side of business doing pricing gear. So just high level, you know, that's kind of like me, my journey at AutoZone, and I'm actually just really interested in hearing from you, like, just tell me about yourself, you know, and then we can, you know, kind of dive and give a resume and experience. Sure, sure. Yeah, so, you know, similar to you, I started my career out at Pfizer. I started first off in like the finance space. I was a finance analyst. At that point, I was working in supporting financial planning analysts, uh, helping them with their decisions by running reports and creating dashboards. And through that, there was opportunities to learn how to automate and create these dashboards and save time for our

analysts. So I was able to take on that opportunity and learn how the RPA robotic process Automation software could help with that. And so within that pilot phase that we were in, the actually Pfizer opened up a department. So I had applied to that and that's where I moved into my second role as a senior analyst in governance and security. So at that point, I was working a little bit less on the financial side, doing more of business analyst work. So I was creating and liaising with the technical personnel and the business and being that middleman between them, making sure that the requirements that the business had were understood by our technical users who were creating and developing the automation that would help create those reports. And so it helped being on both sides of the report user to make sure that the both sides of the team were happy, technical and business. And then again, from there, you, I, you know, found an opportunity within Pfizer again, which led me to my last role as a data enablement manager. And within that role, I was helping create and manage metadata. So that metadata would help but our data and analytics team support their decision, support their storytelling and help them create make business decisions as a factoraster. Okay. That sounds good. So, yeah, I think I've got, you know, several different questions, but let me, I guess, open it up before, you know, asking, I'll jump around. Like, once you're interested in this for all, why is for all why I zone first? So like, I think interest in the role, it aligns a lot with like my background in date and analytics. It's a little bit of a stretch. I know I haven't personally worked with merchandising particularly, particularly, but usually I'm able to pick up things relatively fast. I'm Once I'm able to kind of see and get in there and test out any any scripts and invalidate any outputs. You know, I think of it as just learning another learning another tool. And then for AutoZone, I know AutoZone's been a well- established company in the Memphis area. And so I've been looking to kind of stay here, create that difference, and, you know, kind of be local in the community. I know Ottisan does a lot of community outreach, something I did as well. in Pfizer. So making sure I still and part of the community can be able being able to give back. Well, definitely understand that. So talking about your different roles, like, can you speak to some of the different tools and specifically, like programming languages that you've used I don't, yeah, I don't think it's either onivers. So, yeah, just different programming languages. Yeah, primarily the tools that I had used in the past was Excel, was creating different pivot tables and dashboards within Excel. And so with that, I believe I think I saw in the job description, like SAS or like sequel was part of part of the role. And those typically weren't my primary daily tools, but I have worked extensively, a little bit more extensively with SQL. And so I'm comfortable, I'm comfortable with like data models and joints. So I know like once once I understand the tables and the business logic, the syntax is kind of secondary. So I'm be able to ramp it up quickly. And I would take that as the same approach to any other tools that that are kind of required on the job. Yeah, totally doesn't forget that.s like I mentioned, my background was in accounting. I wasn't exposed to any programming languages until I met first turn show that I was learned a little bit of sequel and in overtime. You know, it kind of built on combat. You know, manage a team that's, obviously the data science portion of it, they're involved in Python, building models and all this that kind of stuff. So But there was more technical than I am, but just old enough to say that totally get that. But, you know, once you start learning a language like sequel or python, let's say, right, NIS in Texas translates. Okay, so how do you use SEquel in any of your current current role or any of previous roles? Yeah, and in my last role, I would use sequel not in necessarily, as I said, you know, primary daily tool, but it would be used to troubleshoot any

issues that came up. So within Calibra, I was, as I said, you know, kind of liaising with our technical team and the business team. And if any variances or differences came up within within the metadata, I would be the one to kind of understand how the ingestion took place. And so that kind of like would look at the sequel on the back end and seeing what areas needed to be corrected. So that's kind of like what I would focus on. Not necessarily creating a statement, but more or less troubleshooting. Okay. Okay. So like in your day-to-day currently, like, what is your day-to-day look like today? What are the different tools and stuff you on interacting with? I'm not sure what you're asking. As far as like application stuff, right, if you're not like, it doesn't sound like you're programming or coding things on a day-to-day specifically staple, I'm not sure if you're doing it to anything else, but like, what is your typical day-to-day look like today?. Yeah, okay, so yeah, I have to have to remember it a little bit. I was impacted by a layoff in Pfizer, so I'm kind of having to think back of, you know, what I did was on a day-to day. I didn't. No, no worries., okay. Yeah, I think on like a primary day-to-day basis, with my last role, it was currently within that. KLIRA dating Intelligence cloud platform. And so I would say it was mainly working with that, working with troubleshooting sequel to our different business partners, you know,, the troubleshooting, the metadata issues and then using looking through the sequel to make sure what issues came about. That was my primary language, primary tools. I would say a lot of my time in day-to-day was talking to the business and understanding their needs and wants and seeing how I could manage my team of developers and working with our project manager to understand the time frame and the bandwidth that our team had. All right. Okay. So who have you interviewed with so far? I interviewed with Christopher Walker, and that's it. Okay. Got it. So did you give you like a lay of the land of the role and what it would entail? What's your understanding of the role you're applying for? Yeah, but you can go ahead and educate me on that. Yeah, no, for sure. So, I guess before I go and get into that one, what are your expectations of this role as far as what you would be doing in day to day? Um My understanding would be being more of like a commercially minded analyst, kind of like looking at the data, looking at how to create a story to be able to help support pricing or promotion or decisions leadership would be making. Yeah, I think I tell that that'll sum that off. So yeah, this team is an interesting one, right? Chris manages it and heads it. So when you look at our organization, there's different typs that analysts go to and each, not only the organization, the organization, but the department. So, you know, Chris is kind of like my kind of counterparts. We don't work directly together day to day, but things come up. So he has the merchandising analysis group, which is in general, they're to kind of like a call prio department. So in merchandising, we have business, what we consider as a business, the merchant side, right? We have category managerers, directors, of merchandise, I think, category manager teams, and BPs, right. They're all responsible for a portion of their business, right? They're responsible for like the buying and the strategies of different products, right? So does that as an example, right? We have batteries, which is one of our oranges, automotive batteries is one of our larger categories, right? That rolls up to a directctor of who's responsible for all things adjacent to like electric products for your reopul, right, starting in charging. And that'll roll up to a VP. So the way that this team is devised, Derek Engel all of the general reporting for the department, all the APIs, and also that when that comes the Hawk andysis and stuff that doesn't fit the mold or maybe fall in between. So when I say like fit the bols in between, we have all these other analyst groups, right? My team paint an example is commercial pricing, right? So I'm responsible specifically for

the analysis and execution of pricing as it relates to the BTB side. We have another BC side that's responsible for retail. We've got analyst two different analysts teams that are responsible for our self assortment, whether it's the front of the store or the the back of the store. Then you've got a supply chain who's just on the branalyzing, obviously the buying the actual physical cutting of the POs and all of that. So all that to say, oldie's a fan analyst group, but then you have kind of merchandising in the middle of it that is responsible for all the general reporting and any other questions that may not be specifically at one different mold, right? So that's where we kind of work in conjunction with one another. The merch analysts in this team are responsible for supporting all these different category managers. The team has evolved a lot over the last couple of years. It's been about probably three, maybe a little more years since I've been on the team. But when I was on the team, I think we had two different directors. So there's like up to eight, 10 different managers who were supporting probably one or two BPs. So it's still kind of like that. But the responsibility for how many indirect ded line the force you have has changed, right? Obviously, you would be reporting up there Chris's team with a solid line, but you'd probably supporting about five different managers up to five different managers. So you'd bere responsible for not only their day to day, week to week, whatever cadence reporting there is, but any insight still looking for an analysis. So basically what you said, just adding a little more detail to it. Does that make sense? Yeah, it does make sense. So thank you for that. I know you said a merch analyst kind of sits in between, you think you said category and what is the other area? Yeah, so in general, within our department, we kind of consider ourselves like the support side, even though we're not like, IT and technical from that side, we're kind of supporting the, we consider more of the business, the merchant side. Merch. So the category managers are responsible for their strategies, right? Where is you to be more so consultants to them and pull data, but not only pull data, and that's something we've changed a lot over the years. And traditionally, have been, folks that you go through just pull data and provide a report and that's not something that Chris orl like. We don't want that, right? Anybody can just pull data. Pulling the insights out of it, right, is completely different. His team is responsible for not only internenal data report reporting, but they're also responsible for market share, third party that we may be subscribing to, for additional stuff. So category of energy just come to them and they'll come with an idea or, you know, Chris would really want somebody who can also pull insights, right? Know that hey, you know, we're all the data that lives, a structure, but rather than being told to go look at something specifically, which we have nothing wrong with that, right? But kind of be curious, right? How that curiosity and try to dive into the data themselves, find patterns, make recommendations, be a consultant to the business, right? So, you know, that's just the mindset, right? So, as I'm looking through your resume, right, it looks like you started as like a financial illness, right? Somebody who's doing more analysis and encouraged me if I'm wrong, right. In your last role, it sounds like, at least a free role that's Dee in front of me, you kind of ended up in more technical roleses, right? Somebody who would be that autoone would probably consider more of an 19 background, right? Your last r says you were data and n manager, right? I'm just wondering, like, oh, what do you want to be doing, right? What is your. What is your ideal role looks like right now and then maybe five to ten years from now? So, yeah, let me just stop there and then I hear your thoughts on that. Yeah, so, I mean, I would I would say you're you're in the right area. You know, I think my last role was slightly technical. I wouldn't say it leans on the technical side. I would kind of say it leans on the on like the business side, working with with the

different teams to highlight any variances and create the outcomes that the business wants. So I would mainly be working with technical teams and making sure that their responsibilities were getting met up to business standards. And so I did like working within the data and analytic space. So kind of like finding meaningful, those like meaningful variances within the data. And then, you know, validating any issues, making sure that those were correct and then, you know, focusing on what actually, would actually change, what actually would change outcomes, you know, finding that meaningful story. And that's kind of what I see myself, you know, in the next, I think we said in the next few years, is kind of staying within that role of being able to find the details and creating the story to be able to help to be able to be that support person. Okay. Can you give me an example of something that comes to mind where you did that in one of your previous roles? You know, I found an insight for whatever stakeholder? Yeah, so I would kind of lean back to like the first role in my, my finance annals position. It's kind of one thing that I'm I'm very proud of. Um, I owned our, uh, KPI dashboard. So, um, that that KPI dashboard tracked our performance of reporting that was on time and accurate. So on time in accuracy. So I made sure to like have the people who needed to make to be making changes within that dashboard, like making sure that they are getting their getting their KPIs on in time so that I can make I can consolidate the data within a timely manner so that I could highlight the highlight the good and the bad. And so, for example, one of the meaningful decisions that I was going to come up with is that if I saw a dip in dip in timeliness, say for like one specific month, I would need to investigate what necessarily happened within that. And so for this example, you know, if it dipped below 90%, you know, that was kind of our threshold, where we wanted to investigate. And so I investigated why the timeliness was diving below 90% for one month, but the month after, you know, it was back up to 98%%. And so from there, I, you know, investigated and saw that our system where we pulled the financial reporting numbers was having issues. So from that, you know, it made sense to say that this was the cause of it. Our our team wasn't able to pull up the numbers that they needed in a timely fashion. And so this is kind of the reason and the story that would be sent up to leadership, why the timeliest head was below threshold. make sense. Okay. So one of the things that, you know, you would consult on in this role a lot is strategy changes, right? It's always, how can we improve ourselves, whether it be attacked or a larger ship more and so and strategy, right? So category managers may come to you, and they're constantly thinking, how can we move our business? They're responsible for products, right? Whether it's enhancing the products somehow or introducing a new line. So let's just say that you're working with the batteries category manager and for this sake of simplicity. Let's just say that today they've got two lines of that batteries, right? A coverage line, right? So you got a good opening price point line. So you got to a better. I didn't catch the first line you said? Yeah, so what we call it coverage, right? So it's your basic line that everybody would go for, right? So it doesn't have crazy bells and whistles, but then meet you have another and point. Right. So think about crap, I'm not an iPhone user, but I don't understand so. But I like, you've got your iPhone maxed, right, then you got your regular iPhone, right? So today, let's just say you've got a standard battery, and then you've got a cheaper battery, right? But now you're thinking about introducing a premium battery, right? This third line would be new. It would have better quality, whatever, right? They're not sure if they want to introduce this third line or not. So as a cons, the consultant to them, what would you say, how would you approach that topic with them?. You know, I believe so for

the instant you're saying, like, there's two lines of batteries and then you're thinking of putting on a third one out there. I think it would kind of, I would think of it as like terms of like trade-off, you know, how much is, you know, what is like the incremental volume that is going to be increased by adding a third battery versus the trade-off of also the decrease in volume of the other two batteries. And. I would also want to.. try to find the story of, you know, whether this is a short-term increase, you know, or versus this could be a better long-term behavior. So I would want to take a look at that comparison. And then I think I also would want to, I would want to understand like the baseline performance of the battery 1 and battery 2. and see if adding that third line would increase like the value of the whole re or just shift demand towards that third line? Yep. Yeah, no, those are valid things I would want to look for, right. And there's different reasons you would do introduce a new line, right? In this case, you're adding a more premium than probably trying improve probability, right? So you, all the things you said, like mixed shift, right? Are you cannibalizing sales? Are you, you know, maybe penetrating the market and getting a bmer now that you weren't getting before? Yeah, so all things that are relevant. So typically, you before making a large investment like that, right? Those are things you would talk through kind of highlight and outline, and then you would want to test for it, right? You're not going to go typically go make a large investment like that in the chain, right? You may take a region or whatever, however you need to test, and introduce it in a a smaller market, see how it performs. So how would you think about forming a test like that just to make sure that, you know, the results you're going to be seeing are representative in accurate. How would I perform the test? Is your question? Yeah. I think I'd lean a little bit towards one. I'd want to take a look at the baseline performance of the battery one and two and then I guess I would see and try to compare if other brands or other lines of batteries has the same type of lineup, you know, a basic premium versus a super premium and try to compare and then look at other lines to see if there is profitability and if the margins are what I'm looking for in that other line to see if a third line would make sense. Okay. Yeah, definitely something you would want to scope at, see what the competitor landscape is. try to look at market share data. Yeah, and then as far as forming it as, what we typically try to do is, you know, we've got 6,000 plus stores, you know, headed towards,500. We would probably go take a market and try to see, hey, what stores are our samples of stores that we go test in and be represented of the chain, right? Batteries is a category right there. If you look at a sale performance, right? There's probably areas of the country that perform better and worse, especially different times of the year. Weather can have a huge play, right. The storage each shoes can have different demographics from an income standpoint or whatever, other feature, right? So those are the type of things that when forming into tests, we try to consult on and say, hey, this is how I would form a test, try to control produced variables, understanding what Mexico they're trying to achieve. and I know we're kind of up on time here. So I just wanted to be sure I give you a couple minutes to ask any questions if you have any. Yes, I mean, I guess in terms of, you know, your day-to-day, you know, like, you know, what decisions are you you relying on analysts, you know, considering like this type of position to support your decisions? Like, are you looking for speed, accuracy, or kind of like comparison to to help your day-to-day? Yeah, I think the Inst has like all of the ball right always wanted it all right, especially when you're talking about leadership. I think. I think when you're hiring for an analyst, roll right. Obviously, we want someone who can technically do the job, right, who can do the programming and stuff, right? That's a big part of it. You know, BM to code, fold the data,

whatever, build dash for. But a large component of it is the communication and the storytelling of it as well, being able to get into the weeds, but then un able to hold that data in whatever we're seeing up to a higher level to tell that story, which I've heard you see multiple times, right. It's it comes down to the storytelling and being able to find that insights and communicate those. yeah.. Okay. Yeah. Thank you for that. Yeah. But yeah, no other questions other than that one. Okay. All right. Well, it was a pleasure talking to you, Kevin. Really appreciate it. Yeah. Appreciate your time. Thank you, Adam. Yeah, had a good one. You as well. Well, that was tough. Didn't expect to be. ask questions on batteries, car batteries specifically. But anyway, we'll see how Chat GBT analyzes this. interview and I'll practice. I'll research more and I'll create more stories and figure out how I can improve. All right. Interview number three coming up next week.